



Above and left: Early Mark III visual-effects concept art (Industrial Light & Magic)

The further development of the Mark III is a not-so-subtle metaphor for the building of the "new" Tony Stark. On the surface, the Mark III represents a cutting-edge offensive weapon with no parallel. But underneath is a subtext that reveals the character's more humane condition: The armor represents its maker's ultimate defense against those who would steal his ideas to inflict violence and inhumanity against the world.